

Information Design [PC746]

M.Des. (Communication Design)

Semester 2

DAU -Gandhinagar

Abstract

Information Design module focuses on transforming complex data into clear, usable information. By utilizing various techniques such as writing, analysis, and design, information designers aim to create meaningful and accessible content that effectively communicates intended messages. This module explores the process of defining, planning, and shaping information to achieve specific objectives and meet the needs of users. Key areas of focus include understanding the target audience, designing intuitive navigation and hierarchy, and using visual elements to enhance engagement and comprehension.

Through case studies, information collection, data analysis, mapping, visualization, and user research, students will develop the skills necessary to create concise, clear, and visually sophisticated communication materials. Ultimately, this module equips students with the ability to structure and present information in a way that promotes understanding, engagement, and effective use.

Course Plan

Day 1-2: User Interaction and Information Processing

- Historical perspective
- How users interact with information
- Cognitive processes: attention, perception, memory, and learning
- Reading and understanding information: typography, layout, and visual hierarchy
- Understanding information types: qualitative, quantitative, and mixed data

Day 3: Information/Data Analysis and Representation (Theoretical approaches)

- Analyzing information: identifying patterns, relationships, and trends
- Introduction to information representation: visual, auditory, and textual
- Visual representation: infographics
- HCD

Day 4: Meaning, Communication, Audio/Visual Aesthetics

- Understanding meaning: context, semantics, and pragmatics
- Communication principles: clarity, concision, and coherence
- Information design for communication: purpose, audience, and message
- Visual aesthetics: color, typography, composition, and imagery
- Auditory aesthetics: sound design, music, and voiceovers
- Multimodal aesthetics: combining visual and auditory elements

Day 5-6: Case Study and Project work (Practical applications)

- Information design Case study and Discussion
- Applying information design principles to a real-world project
- Introduction to design project
- Students work individually to design and develop an information design project

Day 7-8 Project work

- Practical/lab work or Field work
- Progress discussion and feed back

Day 09-10: Project work

- Practical/lab work or Field work
- Progress discussion and feed back

Day 11-12: Project Work

- Practical/lab work or Field work
- Progress discussion and feed back

Day 13: Final Project Presentations

- Students present their final project prototype (Physical / Digital)
- Peer feedback and discussion

Assessment:

Research: 30 Marks

Design Process, Feedback and Interaction: 30 Marks

Project work and Presentation: 40 Marks

Recommended reference book: Information Design- Research and Practice by Alison Black

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

1. Understand how users interact with, read, understand, and use information.
2. Analyze and categorize information according to the required communication focus.
3. Represent information in various forms, emphasizing meaning, communication, and audio/visual aesthetics.

Prepared by

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